some semiliterate voice would say, "French Hospital?"

Each person called us only once, of course, and we would then tell them they had dialed wrong and sometimes they would express regret. (Mostly they would hang up with a bang as though it were our fault they had lost a dime.) To us, though, it seemed as though it were the same person calling us over and over again, stupidly oblivious to his continuing mistake.

I used to have daydreams in which someone would call and say "French Hospital?" and I would say, suavely, "Whom would you like to speak to?" and they would say, "Jane Doe," and I would say, "I'm sorry, but she passed away last night in great agony," and hang up.

Naturally, I never said anything of the sort and wouldn't have said it in reality for anything—but it was a satisfactory daydream.

11

The Orson Welles disappointment (I had long ago given up hope of "Evidence" ever being turned into a movie) had an odd offshoot. On September 28, 1948, I received a letter asking for permission to use "Victory Unintentional" in an anthology that would bear Welles' name as editor. He offered $75 and I accepted.

This was the story Campbell had characterized as "butyl mercap-tan" six years before. It had only netted me $70 when I had first sold it and so this, my third anthologization, was the first that brought me more money for the anthology than for the original sale.

12

The first indication, in my diary, of my growing hatred for the smell of tobacco came on October 7. We went to the movies with the Segals and my diary states: "We sat in the balcony because the Segals wanted to sit there (so they could smoke, I suppose) and, as a result, we couldn't hear well and were choked with tobacco." I was sufficiently indignant at this to add, "I'm averse to going with them anymore."

Gertrude smoked, of course, and I disliked that more and more.

*3

October 12, 1948, was a university holiday because General Dwight D.